

Once in royal David's city

Text: Cecil Frances Alexander, 1848, alt.

Music: Henry John Gauntlett, 1849

IRBY 87.87.77

arr. Arthur Henry Mann, 1919

The musical score is written for a single voice part in G major (one sharp) and 4/4 time. It consists of three staves of music. The first staff contains the first four lines of the hymn, with the lyrics: '1 Once in roy - al Da - vid's cit - y stood a low - ly cat - tle shed, 2 He came down to earth from heav - en who is God and Lord of all, 3 And our eyes at last shall see him, through his own re - deem - ing love; 4 Not in that poor low - ly sta - ble with the ox - en stand - ing by,'. The second staff continues the lyrics: 'where a moth - er laid her ba - by in a man - ger for his bed: and his shel - ter was a sta - ble, and his cra - dle was a stall; for that child so dear and gen - tle is our Lord in heav'n a - bove; we shall see him, but in heav - en set at God's right hand on high;'. The third staff concludes the hymn with the lyrics: 'Ma - ry was that moth - er mild; Je - sus Christ, her lit - tle child. with the poor and meek and low - ly, lived on earth our Sa - vior ho - ly. and he leads his chil - dren on to the place where he is gone. when like stars, his chil - dren crowned all in white, shall wait a - round.' The music features a variety of note values including quarter, eighth, and sixteenth notes, as well as rests and a final double bar line.

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2 He came down to earth from heav - en who is God and Lord of all,
3 And our eyes at last shall see him, through his own re - deem - ing love;
4 Not in that poor low - ly sta - ble with the ox - en stand - ing by,
where a moth - er laid her ba - by in a man - ger for his bed:
and his shel - ter was a sta - ble, and his cra - dle was a stall;
for that child so dear and gen - tle is our Lord in heav'n a - bove;
we shall see him, but in heav - en set at God's right hand on high;
Ma - ry was that moth - er mild; Je - sus Christ, her lit - tle child.
with the poor and meek and low - ly, lived on earth our Sa - vior ho - ly.
and he leads his chil - dren on to the place where he is gone.
when like stars, his chil - dren crowned all in white, shall wait a - round.